

# ETIB

## Interpreter Self-Training Platform

*Ecole de Traducteurs et d'Interpretes de Beyrouth | USJ Beirut*

## User Guide

*For Students and Instructors*

Working languages: Arabic | French | English

**Final Year Project - ESIB, Universite Saint-Joseph**

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## 1. First-Time Setup — Get Your API Key

The platform uses Groq to generate speeches and evaluate your performance. Groq is completely free — you just need your own personal key.

### Step 1 — Create a free Groq account

- Go to [console.groq.com](https://console.groq.com)
- Sign up with your email address (free, no credit card required)
- Once logged in, click **API Keys** in the left menu
- Click **Create API key**, give it a name such as "ETIB", and copy the key — it starts with `gsk_`

*Keep your key private — do not share it with anyone. If it leaks, delete it on [console.groq.com](https://console.groq.com) and create a new one.*

### Step 2 — Save your key in the platform

- Open the ETIB platform and log in
- Click the gear icon (Settings) in the top navigation bar
- Paste your key into the field that shows `gsk_...`
- Click **Test key** — you should see "Key is valid and working"
- Click **Save key**

*Your key is saved only in your browser. No other student or the server can see it. Each student uses their own quota from their own free Groq account.*

## 2. Create an Account and Log In

- Open the platform in your browser
- Click **Create an account**
- Enter your full name, email, and a password (at least 8 characters)
- Select your role: Student, Instructor, or Coordinator
- Click **Create account** — you are logged in automatically

Next time, use **Sign in** with your email and password.

### 3. Module A — Generate a Training Speech

Click **Generate speech** in the navigation bar.

#### Basic generation (topic-only)

- Choose the **Speech language** (AR, FR, or EN — the speaker's language)
- Choose the **Target language** (the language you will interpret into)
- Type a **Topic** (e.g. "climate change", "digital health", "water scarcity")
- Choose a **Domain** and adjust the settings below:

| Setting             | What it does                                     |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Speech length       | Short (~150 words), Medium (~250), Long (~350)   |
| Difficulty          | Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced, Expert         |
| Discourse structure | Argumentative, Narrative, Descriptive, Mixed     |
| Interpretation mode | Consecutive, Simultaneous, Sight translation     |
| Number density      | Controls how many figures and statistics appear  |
| Hesitations         | Adds natural fillers (euh, um, ah) to the speech |
| Pressure mode       | Speed pressure, topic shifts, cognitive load     |

- Click **Generate speech**

The speech appears below. A note tells you whether it was grounded in a real UN document.

#### Document-grounded generation

Upload a PDF, Word, or text file as the source. The platform extracts key content using AI (RAG) and builds the speech around it.

- Expand **Document grounding**
- Click **Choose file** and upload your document
- Adjust settings, then click **Generate from document**

*Click **Preview retrieved context** to see exactly which passages the AI used before generating.*

#### UN Library

Click **UN Library** to search real UN speeches and documents. When you select one, the generated speech will be grounded in actual UN content.

## 4. Module B — Listen and Study

After generating a speech in Module A, click **Audio & materials** in the navigation bar.

### Audio playback

- Choose a voice accent (Lebanese Arabic, Gulf Arabic, Parisian French, etc.)
- Adjust the speech rate for practice pace
- Click **Generate audio** — the audio player appears
- Listen as you would in a booth

### Pedagogical materials

Click **Generate materials** to receive:

| Material            | Description                                              |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Key terms           | 5 important domain-specific terms from the speech        |
| Thematic summary    | A visual tree structure of the main ideas                |
| MCQ                 | 2-3 multiple-choice comprehension questions with answers |
| Open questions      | Discussion questions about the speech content            |
| Trilingual glossary | AR / FR / EN equivalents for the key terms               |

- Click **Download glossary (DOCX)** to save the glossary as an editable Word file

## 5. Module C — Record Your Interpretation

- Click **Record & transcribe** in the navigation bar
- Select the language of YOUR interpretation (not the source speech)
- Click the record button and start interpreting
- Click **Stop** when finished
- Click **Transcribe** — takes 5-15 seconds with Groq, up to 2 minutes with the local fallback

The transcript appears with timestamps. For Arabic, the system adds tashkeel (vowel diacritics) reflecting what you actually pronounced, including errors. Low-confidence words are highlighted — these may indicate pronunciation issues.

## 6. Module D — Get Your Evaluation

Click **Evaluation** in the navigation bar. This module compares your recorded interpretation against the original speech.

### Scores (0 - 100)

| Score    | What it measures                                   |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Overall  | Combined performance score                         |
| Fluency  | Smooth delivery — fewer hesitations = higher score |
| Coverage | How much of the source content you conveyed        |
| Numbers  | Accuracy of numbers, dates, and statistics         |

### Error breakdown

- Hesitations detected (euh, um, ah, ...) — count and positions
- Omissions — content from the source you missed
- Number errors — figures you got wrong or skipped entirely
- Terminology issues — key terms not used in your interpretation

You also receive an AI feedback paragraph. For Arabic, a pronunciation report shows word-by-word confidence scores and likely tashkeel errors.

### Adaptive recommendations

After each session the platform analyses your recent history and recommends a difficulty level, speech length, and domain. Go to Module E and click **Apply these settings** to use them next time.

## 7. Module E — Track Your Progress

Click **Progress** in the navigation bar to see:

- Latest session — your most recent scores at a glance
- Score trend — chart of your last 10 sessions
- Focus areas — skills that are declining or stable and need priority
- Strengths — areas where you are consistently performing well
- Specific errors — your most frequent recurring mistakes
- Recommendations — difficulty and domain suggestions from the AI

*Progress is tracked automatically every time you complete a full evaluation in Module D. You do not need to do anything extra.*

## 8. Tips for Effective Practice

### Module A — Speech generation

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- Move to Advanced difficulty once you score consistently above 75 on Intermediate
- Turn on Hesitations to simulate real speaker conditions
- Use Number density: High if you struggle with figures — a common weak point
- Try the UN Library for authentic content on real UN topics

### Module B — Study materials

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- Study the key terms before listening to reduce cognitive load
- Read the thematic summary to build a mental map of the speech
- Download the glossary and review it the evening before a practice session

### Module C — Recording

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- For simultaneous: start recording as soon as you hear the first sentence
- For consecutive: take the speech segment by segment if you prefer
- Speak clearly — the ASR model works better with clear articulation

### Module D — Evaluation

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- Always use full evaluation with audio — it gives the complete picture
- Focus on one score at a time. If fluency is low, prioritise reducing hesitations
- Read the AI feedback paragraph carefully — it identifies patterns across sessions

### General

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- Practice 20-30 minutes every day rather than once a week for 2 hours
- After each session, check Focus areas in Module E and choose your next topic accordingly

## 9. Troubleshooting

### "No Groq API key found" error

You have not saved your personal API key. Go to the gear icon (Settings), paste your key (gsk\_...), test it, and save it. See Section 1 of this guide.

### "Invalid API key" when testing

- Make sure you copied the full key — it must start with gsk\_
- Keys expire if deleted on console.groq.com — create a new one if needed
- Do not add spaces before or after the key

### Speech generation is slow

Normal generation takes 5-15 seconds. If longer than 30 seconds, you may have hit the Groq free-tier rate limit. Wait 1 minute and try again.

### Transcription takes 2+ minutes

You may have reached the audio limit (2 000 seconds per day). The platform falls back to a local model automatically. Wait until the next day to use Groq Whisper again.

### The recording button does not appear

Your browser needs microphone permission. Click the microphone icon in the address bar, allow access, then reload the page.

### Scores seem too low

The platform is calibrated for conference interpreter training standards. A score of 60-70 is solid for a first attempt. Focus on consistency across sessions.

### "No matching UN document was found"

The UN Library did not find a document matching your topic. The speech is generated without grounding but includes factual accuracy guidelines. Try a more specific topic or a different language.

## Quick Reference

| Action                           | Where to find it                                  |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Add or change your Groq API key  | Gear icon (Settings) in the navigation bar        |
| Generate a training speech       | Module A — Generate speech                        |
| Listen to the speech / get audio | Module B — Audio & materials                      |
| Download the glossary (DOCX)     | Module B > Generate materials > Download glossary |
| Record your interpretation       | Module C — Record & transcribe                    |
| Get your score and AI feedback   | Module D — Evaluation                             |
| See your history and score trend | Module E — Progress                               |
| Apply AI-recommended settings    | Module E > Apply these settings                   |